SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #53 · WORK AND CALLING

“Rest is laziness, even when God commands it.”

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Where it often comes from

Families that prized hard work may have called rest “wasting time.” Cultures that celebrate busyness reinforce it. Even people who know the Sabbath is a command may feel guilty for taking it, especially when money is tight and there seems to be more to do than hours to do it.

What Scripture teaches

God told Israel, “Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy. Six days you shall labor and do all your work, but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD your God.” Jesus said, “The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath.” The psalmist says, “In vain you rise early and stay up late, toiling for bread to eat—for He gives sleep to His beloved.” Jesus invites, “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest,” and told His disciples, “Come with Me privately to a solitary place, and let us rest for a while.” Rest is obedience.

> *“Then Jesus declared, ‘The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath.’”* (Mark 2:27).

Also see

> “Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy. Six days you shall labor and do all your work, but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD your God, on which you must not do any work—neither you, nor your son or daughter, nor your manservant or maidservant or livestock, nor the foreigner within your gates” (Exodus 20:8–10).

> “In vain you rise early and stay up late, toiling for bread to eat— for He gives sleep to His beloved” (Psalm 127:2).

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest” (Matthew 11:28).

> “And He said to them, ‘Come with Me privately to a solitary place, and let us rest for a while.’ For many people were coming and going, and they did not even have time to eat” (Mark 6:31).

Common self-statements

- I cannot afford to rest.
- Resting is lazy.
- There is always more to do.
- If I rest, I will fall behind.
- Others work harder than I do.
- I have to earn my rest.

Common logical errors

- Should statements: Insisting that I should always be working.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing myself as either productive or lazy.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding that rest is wrong.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining that a day off will lead to ruin.

Challenging questions

- Who taught me that rest is laziness?

- What did God do on the seventh day, and what does He command?
- What did Jesus do when He was tired?
- What does Psalm 127:2 say about God giving sleep to His beloved?
- What happens to my work, health, and family when I never rest?
- What is one way I could rest this week?

Truth summary

> Rest is a gift and a command from God, not laziness. The Sabbath was made for me. I can rest without guilt, trusting that God provides while I sleep and cares for what I cannot finish.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Tired
- Sleep Problems
- Laziness
- Obedience
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Prayer

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Oh My Soul — Casting Crowns
Honest distress can coexist with faith and hope in God.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Rest is laziness, even when God commands it"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Rest is laziness, even when God commands it." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who taught me that rest is laziness?
- ☐ What did God command?
- ☐ What did Jesus do when tired?
- ☐ What happens when I never rest?
- ☐ What can I trust God with?
- ☐ When will I rest this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Sabbath was made for me.
- ☐ God gives sleep to His beloved.
- ☐ Jesus invites the weary to rest.
- ☐ Rest is obedience, not laziness.
- ☐ I can trust God with unfinished work.
- ☐ Rest helps me serve better.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Mark 2:27
  "Then Jesus declared, 'The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath.'"
- ☐ Psalm 127:2
  "In vain you rise early and stay up late, toiling for bread to eat— for He gives sleep to His beloved."
- ☐ Matthew 11:28
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Rest received: Each week, write one way you rested and how it felt.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Mark 2:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Sabbath was made for me, so I can rest without guilt.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Tired" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Name the message. Write who taught you that rest is lazy.
- [ ] Plan a Sabbath. Choose a block of time each week to rest, pray, and enjoy.
- [ ] Sleep enough. Set a bedtime and protect it.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 127:2. Thank God for sleep as a gift.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Rest is laziness, even when God commands it": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Rest received
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Rest is laziness, even when God commands it.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You commanded rest and gave it as a gift. Free me from guilt about stopping. Teach me to trust You with what I leave undone and to receive rest as Your love. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.